PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM, EDR/XDR and Security Operations

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience taking technical ownership of enterprise security infrastructure across global, multi-site environments. I specialise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platform management, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) alert response, email and web security gateway administration, and security architecture. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I managed a 8,000-user security estate, implementing and hardening CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender platforms, coordinating penetration test remediation programmes, and delivering security awareness training via KnowBe4-equivalent platforms. I am seeking a hybrid permanent role within a small, high-calibre security team where I can apply deep technical expertise across SIEM, EDR/XDR, identity, and infrastructure security.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL), detection rule engineering, alert triage, SOAR playbook automation
- **EDR and XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender (M365D)
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony Firewall
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Security Awareness:** Phishing simulation and security awareness training programme delivery
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR playbook development
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, threat intelligence integration, security architecture review

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2022 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Hold technical ownership of the university-wide security technology estate spanning 8,000 users across multiple sites, ensuring platforms are implemented, maintained, and hardened to current security standards.
- Oversee email and web security gateways including Mimecast and Check Point Harmony, managing rule sets, threat intelligence feeds, and gateway policy hardening to defend against phishing, malware, and data exfiltration.
- Administer and tune CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (KQL-based), and SOAR platforms; engineer detection rules aligned with MITRE ATT&CK, reducing alert noise and improving signal fidelity across the estate.
- Lead EDR/XDR alert response across CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), triaging and investigating incidents from initial detection through containment and remediation.
- Coordinate penetration testing engagements (Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck) and lead structured remediation programmes, tracking findings through to closure and reporting progress to the IT Security Officer.

- Contribute to ad hoc security architecture projects, providing technical input on new system designs, cloud integrations, and third-party vendor assessments.
- Deliver the security awareness training programme including phishing simulations, face-to-face briefings, and eLearning campaigns for 8,000+ staff and students.
- Manage Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, governing access for administrators and service accounts across the enterprise.
- Administer Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO) integrations, enforcing zero-trust identity controls.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed SIEM alert triage and incident response for a 8,000-user environment, handling EDR, identity, and gateway alerts across a blended Microsoft and CrowdStrike security stack.
- Authored and tuned Microsoft Sentinel detection rules using KQL; built workbooks and dashboards to give the security team operational visibility across cloud and hybrid infrastructure.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Insight EDR to protect endpoints across the university, configuring prevention policies and sensor tagging for structured alert management.
- Supported the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) as part of a Microsoft 365 security uplift, extending detection coverage to 8,000 devices and identities.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus; compiled risk-prioritised remediation reports and tracked remediation to closure against agreed service level agreements.
- Maintained Conditional Access policies and Azure AD / Entra ID security configurations, enforcing least-privilege access and step-up authentication for high-risk sign-ins.
- Contributed to the university's Cyber Essentials Plus certification programme and supported alignment activities against ISO 27001 and CIS Controls.
- Produced security operations reports and threat briefings for senior stakeholders, translating technical findings into business risk language.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed end-to-end IT security and infrastructure for a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech platform serving global enterprise clients, applying ISO 27001 and CIS Controls to protect multi-tenant cloud environments.
- Performed security quality assurance on software releases, identifying and tracking security defects through to resolution in collaboration with development and DevOps teams.
- Administered endpoint protection, identity management (Azure AD), and network security controls including firewall policy management and secure remote access.
- Managed IT infrastructure including server provisioning, network maintenance, and device lifecycle management via Microsoft Intune and Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM).
- Supported internal IT audit and compliance activities, contributing evidence for security certifications and client due diligence questionnaires.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/Prevent to over 8,000 endpoints across a dispersed, multi-site university estate, achieving full endpoint visibility and enabling real-time threat detection and prevention at scale.
- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) as part of a Microsoft 365 security transformation, delivering integrated threat protection across 8,000 users and devices.
- Engineered a library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, significantly improving signal fidelity and reducing manual alert investigation time for the security operations team.
- Built SOAR automation playbooks for high-volume, low-complexity alert types, freeing analyst capacity for higher-value threat hunting and incident response activities.
- Coordinated a successful Cyber Essentials Plus certification programme, ensuring the university met the government-endorsed standard for baseline cyber hygiene across the entire estate.

- Established and maintained a vulnerability management programme across Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, delivering quarterly risk reduction reports to the IT Security Officer and senior leadership.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)